



MARYJOY ETHIOPIA

SINCE 1994



2024

ANNUAL REPORT

Contents

BOARD MEMBERS	VI
MANAGEMENT MEMBERS	VII
MESSAGE FROM CHAIRPERSON OF THE BOARD	VIII
MESSAGE FROM EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR	IX
1. INTRODUCTION	1
2. PERFORMANCE REVIEW FOR FISCAL YEAR 2024: A COMPREHENSIVE ASSESSMENT OF OUR PHYSICAL AND FINANCIAL ACHIEVEMENTS	2
2.1 Livelihood Enhancement and Economic Strengthening	3
2.2 Public Health Program	4
2.2.1 Health Awareness Education Services	5
2.2.2 Diagnostic Services	5
2.2.3. Treatment and Curative Services	5
2.2.4 Counseling and Psycho-Social Support	6
2.3 Education Program	7
2.3.1 Access to Education	7
2.3.2 Educational Quality	7
2.4 Social Protection Program	9
2.4.1 Public-Private-Partnership	9
2.4.2 Diaspora Movement and engagement	13
2.4.3 Street Children and Elders Protection, Support and Rehabilitation	13
2.4.3.1 Gedam Sefer Street Children Center	13
2.4.3.2 Hawassa Elders ' Center	15
2.4.3.3 Arbaminch Elders' Center	16
2.4.3.4 Feeding program	17
2.4.4 Volunteerism	17
2.5 Resource Mobilization and Partnership	19
2.5.1 Resource Mobilization	19
2.5.2 Partnership	20
2.6 Program Management Capacity Building	21
2.6.1 Human Resources Utilization and Capacity Development	21

2.6.2 Strengthening Program Management, Governance and Operational Systems	21
2.6.2.1 Operational Policies and Guidelines	21
2.6.2.2 Enhancing the digital system and website	22
2.7 Monitoring and Evaluation	22
2.8 Strengthening the Organizational Resource Base and Sustainability	25
2.8.1 Income Generating Activities	25
2.8.1.1 Expansion and Construction of Asco Primary Hospital	25
2.8.1.2 Expansion and Construction of Hawassa Primary Hospital	25
2.8.1.3 Foundation stone laid for Arba Minch Street Children Center	26
2.8.1.4 Construction of Hosanna Elders' Center	26
2.8.1.5 Income generating shops	26
3. FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE	27
3.1 Income	27
3.2 Expenditure	27
4. PROBLEMS ENCOUNTERED AND ACTIONS TAKEN	28
4.1 Problems Encountered	28
4.2 Remedial Actions Taken	28
5. ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS	29
5.1 International Donor Agencies	29
5.2 Institutions/Companies/Individuals That Sponsor 100 or More Children	29
5.3 Individuals/Organizations that supported the construction of ASCO Primary Hospital	29
6. EXTERNAL AUDITORS' REPORT	31
7. ANNEXES	37
7.1 Success Stories	37
Women Empowerment in Action: The "Yelem Liyunet" VSLA Journey	37
Resilience in Adversity:" Melat's Journey to Empowerment"	38
FY 2025 Budget	39
FY2025 Budget Plan by Cost Category/Programs	39

ACRONYMS

IDS	Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome
ANC	Antenatal Care
BDS	Business Development Services
BMSF	Bristol Myers Squibb Foundation
CSO	Civil Society Organization
ECNA	Ethiopia Community Nutrition Activity
EPI	Expanded Program on Immunization
Fhi 360	Family Health International 360
FP	Family Planning
GAIN	Global Alliance for Improved Nutrition
HIV	Human immunodeficiency virus
IGA	Income Generating Activity
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
MJE	Mary Joy Ethiopia
NGO	Non-governmental Organization
OPD	Outpatient Departments
OVC	Orphan and Vulnerable Children
PLC	Private Limited Company
RMNCH	Reproductive, Maternal, and Newborn Child Health
SHG	Self Help Group
SNV	Stichting Nederlandse Vrijwilligers (Netherlands Development Organization)
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
VSLA	Village Saving and Loan Association

VISION

MJE strives to be a sustainable organization that brings about lasting improvement in the lives of its target groups

MISSION

Mary Joy Ethiopia is an Ethiopian resident charity that works to empower vulnerable and underserved community groups through integrated development programs

GOAL

Improved the livelihood & health wellbeing of the target communities to contribute to the achievement of Ethiopia's development goals and the SDGs.

OBJECTIVES

- Improve livelihood and reduce inequality among target communities
- Improve access and quality education to the target school age children
- Enhance the health wellbeing of the target communities
- Increase MJE's resource solicitation capacity and execution capability

STRATEGIES

- Community mobilization, sensitization and Awareness Creation
- Collaboration, Partnership
- Integrated Programming: research-based integrated programming approach to address the needs of target beneficiaries
- Mainstreaming of cross-cutting issues of gender development, child empowerment, protection, ASRH and inclusiveness
- Marketing, promotion and branding
- Resource mobilization
- Internal capacity building & physical infrastructure development

CORE VALUES

- Commitment
- Transparency and accountability
- Integrity/trustworthiness
- Empowerment
- Teamwork
- Respect

BOARD MEMBERS



Mr. Yismashewa Siyum
Board Chairperson



Mr. Amare Kassa
Deputy Chair



Mr. Kasaye Lemma
Board Members



Mrs. Addis Zelekaw
Board Members



Mrs. Workinesh Daba
Board Members



Mr. Aynalem Yigzaw
Board Members

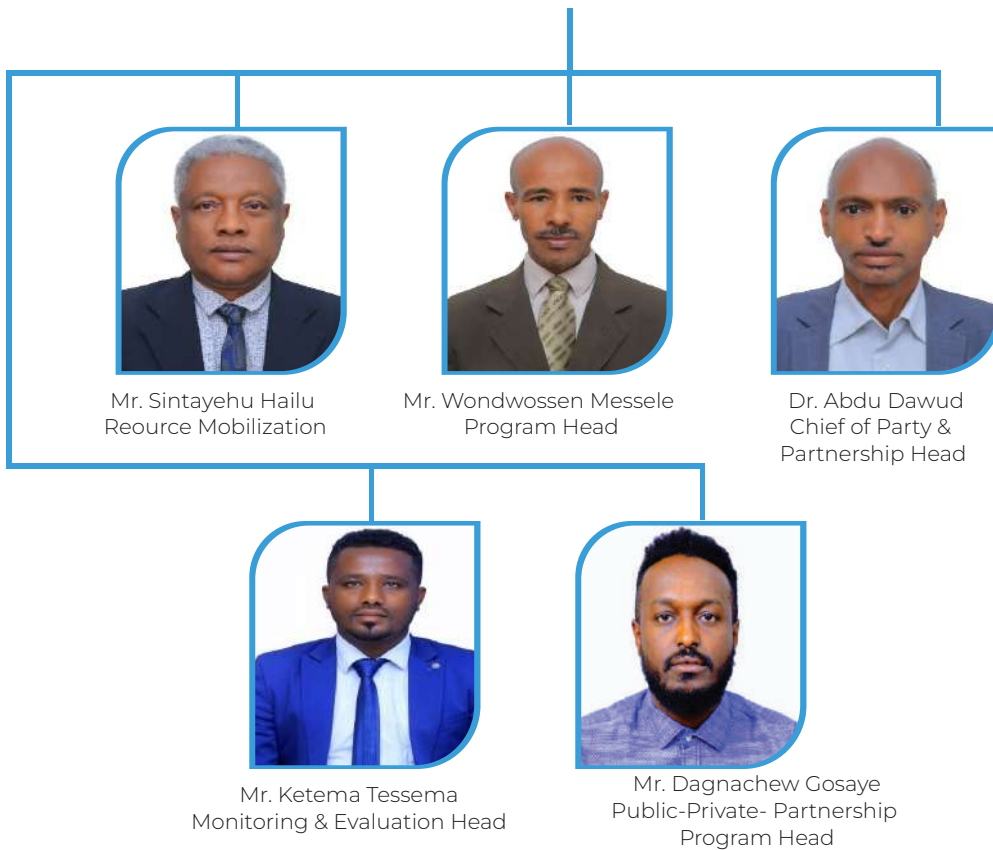


Mrs. Wubit Assefa
Board Members

MANAGEMENT MEMBERS



Sr. Zebider Zewdie
Founder & Executive Director



MESSAGE FROM CHAIRPERSON OF THE BOARD



Dear Mary Joy Ethiopia Families,

Ethiopia has faced numerous socioeconomic challenges, instigating the government to implement various policies and homegrown economic interventions to lift vulnerable communities above the poverty line. As a key duty bearer, Mary Joy Ethiopia has been executing integrated development initiatives that have produced tangible results and improvements in the lives of the targeted communities. Over the last three decades, the organization has established a lasting legacy and significantly aided the accomplishment of national development objectives.

MJE has recognized the increasing vulnerability of citizens, particularly children, women, mothers, and the elderly, to the challenges associated with street situations. The organization has made significant strides in addressing this issue. Notably, it has

established two rehabilitation centers that provide essential services to street children and mothers. Moreover, an elder care center in Arbaminch has begun service this fiscal year. To tackle these challenges collaboratively, MJE organized high-level advocacy meetings involving government officials, the private sector, and influential community members to raise public awareness and engage duty bearers more effectively.

In the fiscal year 2024, Mary Joy Ethiopia completed its planned activities across several areas, including livelihood enhancement, public health, education, public-private partnerships, and community and institutional capacity building. These efforts took place in five regions and one city administration: South Ethiopia, Sidama, Central Ethiopia, Southwest Ethiopia, Oromia, and Addis Ababa. MJE also commenced health project implementation in the Gurage Zone, three woredas. Key program components, including support for street children, mothers, adolescent sexual and reproductive health (ASRH), HIV prevention, care, and support, as well as inclusiveness, received special attention during implementation. Two significant projects have been initiated this fiscal year: the construction of Asko Primary Hospital in Addis Ababa and Hawassa Primary Hospital in Hawassa city. This past year, the organization achieved a remarkable income performance of 261,623,593.42 birr, surpassing the planned target by 148 % and reflecting a 48% increase from the previous year.

In the upcoming period, the organization aims to expand its programs, scale up operations, and increase the number of target groups as well as its geographic reach. At Mary Joy, we are dedicated to enhancing the livelihoods of the communities we serve. Finally, I would like to express my sincere appreciation to all members of the Mary Joy family, the general assembly, the board members, and the volunteers for their contributions. I encourage everyone to continue their efforts. Congratulations to all of you for successfully achieving the planned activities!

I extend my best wishes for peace and unity to our country and its people. Thank you

Yismashewa Seyoum
Chairperson of the Board

MESSAGE FROM EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR



Dear Mary Joy
Families,
Members and
Stakeholders,

I am very excited to present MJE's annual performance report for 2024 to all partners and stakeholders. It is a clear fact that our world is facing many challenges due to various man-made and natural problems. This situation has also made many people vulnerable to various social, economic and political crises. Similar problems are seen in our country, Ethiopia. We are at a time when many people are facing social, economic and political problems and are in great need of support. To address this need, Mary Joy Ethiopia has made many efforts to empower vulnerable and underserved community groups through integrated development programs.

Throughout 2024, Mary Joy Ethiopia implemented various resource mobilization, reaching many vulnerable target groups within the local community and the private sector. Our approach focused on maximizing resource solicitation through local public-private partnerships, successfully addressing budget constraints faced by some projects and allowing for the implementation of planned activities. We have been able to carry out work that has benefited many people by using diversified strategies and coordinated fundraising efforts.

Our organization has been executing a public-private sector partnership program that significantly reduced reliance on external donor funds. As detailed in the report, during the fiscal year, many vulnerable children, caregivers, women, youth, vulnerable elderly people, people living with HIV, and other segments of the community benefited from the integrated services provided by the organization. In terms of beneficiaries, 6,488 communities have benefited from economic capacity building, 159,308 from health services, 76,995 from education services, and 17,964 from public-private partnership programs. These programs are successful owing to our ability to strengthen the organization's human resources, professionalism, and the presence of highly experienced individuals.

In addition, the ASCO Medical Center has made significant progress in service delivery, operational improvements, and revenue generation. Income-generating shops have been built, revenue is being collected, and the construction of Asco primary hospital is 70% complete. Furthermore, the construction of a new primary hospital in Hawassa City has begun this fiscal year. In the next fiscal year, we will make great efforts to strengthen our implementation capacity, provide better services to our main beneficiaries, namely vulnerable children, youth, women, the elderly and their families, and expand our reach to different regions.

Finally, I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to governmental and non-governmental organizations, the business community, and the Diaspora community for their unwavering support of our mission. I also extend my thanks to the leadership and staff of MJE for their contributions to our achievements and the positive changes we have made. Your direct support, engagement, cash and in-kind donations, and the efforts of philanthropists have been invaluable.

I always receive in return for my bestows!

God bless Ethiopia and its people

Sr. Zebider Zewdie, Founder & Executive Director

1. INTRODUCTION

During the period under review, Mary Joy Ethiopia has been implementing a variety of projects aimed at enhancing livelihoods, improving health, strengthening the economy, and fostering public partnerships. These efforts span six regions, namely Oromia Region, South Ethiopia Region, Sidama Region, Southwest Ethiopia Region, Central Ethiopia Region, and Addis Ababa, covering a total of 73 Woredas and 342 Kebeles.

The health program is a key component of our organization's efforts. Over the years, we have been providing both preventive and curative health care services at the community and facility levels. Our services encompass prevention, control, treatment, and care. These services have been delivered through the MJE clinics and in collaboration with government health facilities. During the reporting period, we reached a total of 159,308 community members with various health services. Of this total, MJE clinics provided services to 42,993 individuals in the surrounding communities. Through livelihood enhancement program, we provided economic strengthening support to 6,488 women, caregivers of street children, youth, and working elders. Women and caregivers of street children received a total of 16,335,500.00 Birr as startup capital support. Mary Joy has worked to improve access to education and the educational performance of targeted children while focusing on the implementation of quality education. As a result, 76,995 children have benefited from educational services.

During the reporting period, we provided sponsorship support to 5,787 children and 896 elders. We also delivered integrated services to 526 individuals, including street children, adults, women, and elders, through our elder center, full shelter, and day care centers, as well as through home-to-home services. Additionally, we offered vocational skill training to adults and elders to promote self-reliance, resulting in many of them being successfully reunited with their families. During the review period, the construction of elder center in Arbaminch has completed and entered into the services. A new project, Ethiopia Community Nutrition Activity (ECNA) has been initiated in 10 woredas (161 of kebeles) in Sidama Region.

In terms of financial performance, the organization collected 261,623,593.42 birr, which is 148% of the annual budget plan of 230,583,420.00 Birr. Out of this total income, 248,477,624.78 Birr (95%) was utilized, with 89.9% allocated for program operations and 10.1% dedicated to administrative expenses.

2. PERFORMANCE REVIEW FOR FISCAL YEAR 2024: A COMPREHENSIVE ASSESSMENT OF OUR PHYSICAL AND FINANCIAL ACHIEVEMENTS

During the review period, Mary Joy Ethiopia has embarked on a significant journey, implementing various impactful projects aimed at addressing the diverse needs of the communities we serve. Our major projects and programs include:

- Highly Vulnerable Children and Elders Support Program: This initiative focuses on providing comprehensive assistance, ensuring that the most at-risk children and elderly individuals receive essential services, care, and support to improve their quality of life.
- Urban Poverty Reduction Project: Through targeted efforts, we address the acute challenges faced by street children, adults, and elders. Our program offers a lifeline, providing vital support services that aim to reduce urban destitution and empower individuals to reintegrate into society.
- Lung Cancer Prevention, Diagnosis, and Treatment Project: We conduct awareness raising and combating lung cancer through prevention initiatives, early diagnosis programs, and accessible treatment options, all designed to promote healthier lives and communities.
- USAID Family-Focused HIV Prevention, Care, and Treatment Activity: This essential program provides comprehensive care and support to families affected by HIV. It aims to enhance community health outcomes while addressing and mitigating the stigma associated with the disease. Through its multifaceted approach, the program fosters resilience and promotes a supportive environment for those impacted by HIV.
- Social Behavioral Change Project: The project focuses on promoting healthier lifestyles and instilling positive health behaviors within communities. The initiative seeks to provide comprehensive education and empower individuals by equipping them with the knowledge and resources necessary to take proactive measures in managing and improving their health.
- Integrated Community Health Program: With dedicated efforts in Addis Ababa and Hawassa, this program enhances health outcomes by providing holistic health services and promoting community engagement in health initiatives.
- Children and Youth Center Services: We are actively constructing Rehabilitation Centers for Elders and Street Children in Addis Ababa, Hosana, and Arbaminch. These will serve as safe havens, offering crucial support and rehabilitation to those in need.
- Rehabilitation and Socio-Economic Reintegration Program: Focused on street mothers, children, and youth. This program emphasizes not only rehabilitation but also the socio-economic reintegration of these individuals, helping them regain their dignity and independence.
- Education and Vocational Training Program: This program is designed to create meaningful opportunities for school-aged individuals and youth from high-vulnerable communities through the establishment of strong public-private partnerships.
- Income Generating Schemes: Mary Joy Ethiopia has established various income-generating schemes aimed at ensuring the sustainability of the organization.

These initiatives include upgrading existing clinical centers to primary hospitals in Addis Ababa and Hawassa, constructing shops for rent, and operationalizing the Flour Factory P.L.C. in Dodola, West Arsi Zone.

- Through these initiatives, Mary Joy Ethiopia exemplifies its unwavering commitment to empower vulnerable populations, enhance public health, and foster sustainable development within our communities.

2.1. Livelihood Enhancement and Economic Strengthening

Livelihood enhancement represents a pivotal initiative within the framework of MJE's program, with the objective of facilitating sustainable positive transformations in the well-being of targeted communities. This program provides support to caregivers of vulnerable and at-risk children, returning irregular migrants, aspiring migrants, unemployed youth, and socio-economically disadvantaged women.

Throughout the review period, the primary activities executed within this program segment encompassed training in Business Development Services (BDS), life skills, entrepreneurship development, mentorship, and knowledge-sharing initiatives. Furthermore, the program allocated initial capital, both in cash and in-kind resources, to promote the establishment of start-up enterprises. In alignment with these objectives, the subsequent activities have been undertaken. Here are the key achievements during the reporting period:

- A total of 2,626 self-supporting groups and Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs) have been successfully established and empowered, highlighting the powerful impact of community collaboration and collective growth. This achievement reflects the potential for positive change when individuals come together to support one another. Currently, there are 438 Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs) with a total of 6,488 active members engaged in business activities.
- The VSLA group received training in life skills and Business Development Services (BDS), along with startup capital to help them initiate their own small-scale businesses. Mary Joy Ethiopia also assisted participants in opening bank accounts at the Commercial Bank of Ethiopia and Addis International Bank, enabling them to start saving to expand and diversify their businesses.
- Collectively, these groups have saved 11,164,373.00 birr and provided loans birr 5,492,580.00 to 3,931 members. The loan repayment procedures are governed by bylaws that have been collectively endorsed by the VSLA members. These initiatives are being implemented in various locations, including Addis Ababa, Bishoftu, Hawassa, Dilla, Hossana, Arbaminch, Wolaita Sodo, Jinka, Butajira, Mizan Aman, Tepi, Bonga, and Yirgalem, Guraghe zone, and Mareko special woreda.
- Start-up capital was effectively allocated for business ownership through the transfer of assets, while market linkages were successfully established.

Program Impacts

The business skills of members in the Village Savings and Loan Association (VSLA) and Self-Help Group (SHG) have improved significantly. As a result, their incomes have increased, and their saving habits have strengthened. Members have become self-reliant and are now able to cover their families' basic needs, educational expenses, health costs, and more. They are also engaged in sustainable income-generating activities.

2.2. Public Health Program

Mary Joy Ethiopia's public health program is dedicated to fostering healthier and more resilient communities by prioritizing the health and well-being of individuals through a holistic approach. This initiative encompasses addressing various determinants of health, including disease prevention, access to healthcare, health education, social determinants, and community empowerment, thereby enabling individuals to take control of their health outcomes. To fulfill its health objectives, Mary Joy Ethiopia has been implementing a series of activities that acknowledge the multifaceted advantages of health interventions. These interventions aim to improve overall health outcomes and enhance access to essential health services within communities. The main public health interventions include:

- Community healthcare Services: This includes both preventive and curative care.
- HIV Prevention, Care, and Services: These initiatives aim to reduce the risk of HIV transmission and provide essential support for those affected.
- Cervical Cancer Prevention and Care: This encompasses prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and ongoing care based on the TELL-SEE-TREAT-CARE approach. It also includes comprehensive cervical cancer prevention, initial diagnosis, and referral pathways for further evaluation, treatment, and support services.
- Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child Health, and Family Planning (RMNCH/FP) Services: These services are available in both community and facility settings.
- Various Health Services: These address both communicable and non-communicable diseases.

2.2.1. Health Awareness Education Services



Figure 1: Community health education program

During the fiscal year, 48,809 community members (130% of the target) received health education aimed at increasing community health awareness, encouraging preventive behavior changes, and reducing vulnerability. This high level of achievement can be attributed to the intensive health awareness training conducted by Mary Joy Clinics and various community health projects. The health awareness education covered essential topics such as protecting against sexual violence and harassment, preventing HIV and lung cancer, promoting the benefits of a balanced diet for pregnant and lactating mothers, reproductive health education, building self-confidence and communication skills, and personal and environmental hygiene awareness. This ongoing awareness campaign has been strengthened through increased focus and engagement, utilizing a variety of methods including volunteers, informational leaflets, interactive workshops, videos, drama, and other activities. As a result, there has been a significant increase in the number of beneficiaries served.

2.2.2. Diagnostic Services

Our clinical centers provide a comprehensive array of diagnostic services designed to address the diverse requirements of our patients. We offer advanced imaging modalities, including ultrasound and X-ray, which facilitate precise evaluations of various medical conditions. Furthermore, we deliver specialized services such as immunization through the Expanded Program on Immunization (EPI), antenatal care (ANC), and dedicated outpatient departments catering to both pediatric and adult patients. Our fully equipped laboratory performs a wide range of tests, ensuring prompt and reliable results. We place significant emphasis on critical areas, including tuberculosis diagnosis and treatment, alongside specialized screenings for lung cancer, thereby enabling us to deliver timely and effective care. Consequently, we have successfully administered diagnostic services to a total of 30,776 patients at our clinical centers, surpassing our target by 107%.

Cervical cancer screening services are offered at Mary Joy Clinics, as well as in eleven cities where the Family-Based HIV/AIDS Prevention, Support, and Treatment Service Project is operational. These locations encompass the Southern Regional State (Dila, Sodo, Arba Minch, and Jinka), the Central Ethiopia Regional State (Butajira and Hosanna), Southwestern Ethiopia (Bonga, Mizan Aman, and Tepi), and the Sidama Regional State (Yirgalem and Hawassa).

Initially, a total of 265 women living with HIV, alongside other community groups, were designated to receive services at government health facilities. However, the final count of women provided with services reached 351, achieving 132% of the initial objective. This increase is attributed to a greater than anticipated demand from service seekers.

2.2.3. Treatment and Curative Services

In the cities where the Family-Based HIV/AIDS Prevention, Support, and Treatment Service Project is actively implemented, specifically Dila, Sodo, Arba Minch, Jinka, Butajira, Hosanna, Bonga, Mizan Aman, Tepi, Yirgalem, and Hawassa, we have successfully reached 1,172 individuals living with HIV. This represents an achievement 79.3% of our targeted goal of 1,478 patients. Clinical services at MJE's health facilities in Addis Ababa and Hawassa

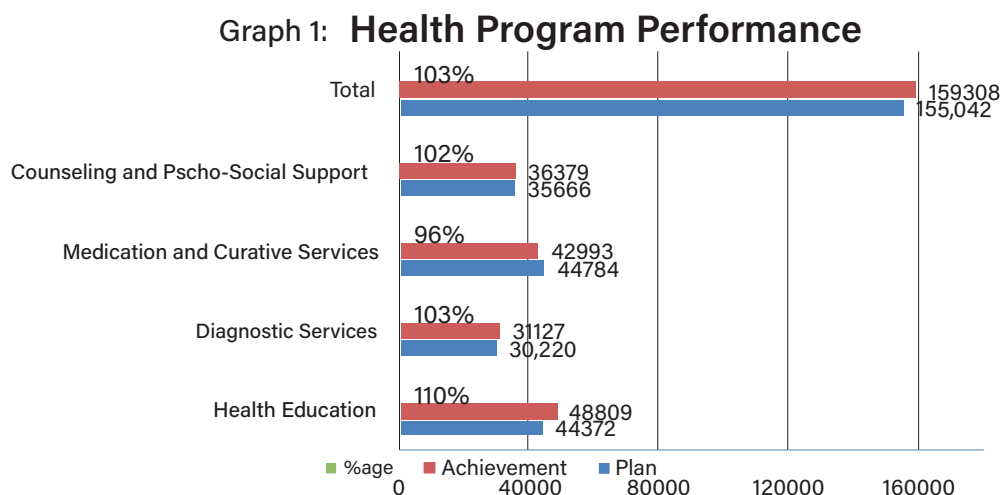
have enhanced the health and well-being of 42,993 community members, achieving 102% of the desired target. The significant strides made in enhancing health facilities have had a profound impact on the well-being of community, illustrating the effectiveness of targeted health interventions. With an impressive achievement of 102% of the set goals, these efforts not only underscore the commitment to improving healthcare access but also reflect a robust strategy that prioritizes community needs. This remarkable progress not only fosters healthier lifestyles but also sets a strong foundation for ongoing health initiatives that can further uplift and empower the community. Accordingly, a total of 2,696 children have received immunization services, reaching 111% of the intended target, 1,058 women have had family planning services, meeting 98% of the target, 106 women have gotten delivery services, surpassing the intended goal of 236%, 478 elders have received free medical care, reaching 104% of the target and ANC services have been provided to 1,228 moms, exceeding the intended goal of 108%.

2.2.4. Counseling and Psycho-Social Support

It was possible to provide counseling and psycho-social support services to 3,570 people living with HIV to properly monitor their antiretroviral medication intake (116% of the plan), and the high performance was due to the entry of new HIV-positive people into the service. A health awareness project is underway in two woredas of Guraghe Zone and Mareko Special Woreda in Central Ethiopia Region. During the fiscal year, awareness raising; home to home family health monitoring and support; pregnant mother conference; maternal health consultation groups; Dads or fathers of children under 5 years of age, prenatal care, postnatal care, family planning, and nutrition of infants and children under 5 years of age, gender transformative male engagement, etc., were provided to 32,809 communities groups.



Figure 2: Women's (Mom) group discussion in Goto Mendifa Kebele, and men's (Dad) group discussion in Goto Gotbale Kebele, in Marekko Special District



2.3. Education Program

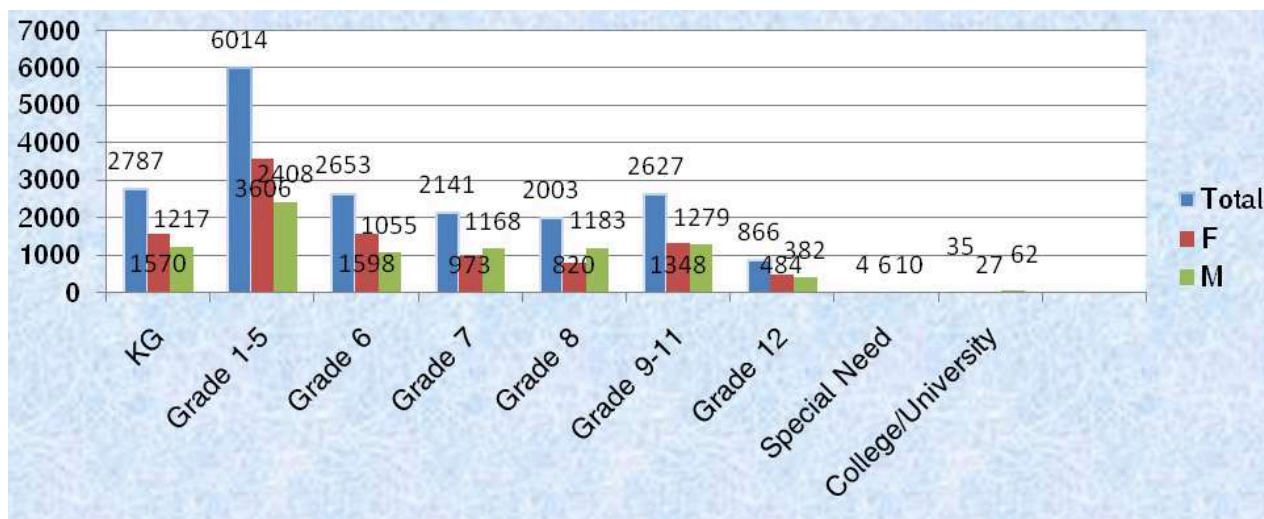
Mary Joy Ethiopia comprehends the crucial role of education in driving transformation and breaking the cycle of intergenerational poverty at the family, community, and national levels. With this belief, Mary Joy Ethiopia (MJE) has implemented a variety of services within its education program over the past year, focusing on two key areas: increasing access to education and improving educational quality. To enhance access to education, MJE has provided essential scholastic materials and offered free scholarships to vulnerable and homeless children. For improving educational quality, the organization has implemented tutorial support, monitored the academic performance of targeted children, and provided counseling services.

Additionally, MJE has facilitated library services and computer training through its children and youth centers, along with empowerment initiatives for children. These initiatives aim to enhance and expand educational opportunities for individuals in need. These initiatives are being implemented in various locations, including Addis Ababa, Bishoftu, Hawassa, Dilla, Hosana, Arbaminch, Wolaita Sodo, Jinka, Butajira, Mizan Aman, Tepi, Bonga, and Yirgalem.

2.3.1. Access to Education

In its educational program, Mary Joy Ethiopia has implemented monitoring and counseling services aimed at enhancing educational access and performance for children. The initiative provides remedial education support, thereby improving the educational outcomes of beneficiary children through effective community mobilization, resource mobilization, and coordination. This comprehensive approach ensures the delivery of services across the cities in which the project operates. During the 2024 academic year, data indicated a significant increase in the number of students supported by Mary Joy Ethiopia. A total of 19,163 children, representing 152% of the initially planned figure of 12,645, received educational assistance this year.

Graph2 : OVC Access to Education by Sex Disaggregation



2.3.2. Educational Quality

Mary Joy Ethiopia is executing a range of constructive initiatives aimed at enhancing students' academic performance for the 2025 academic year. A principal element of these efforts is the Hawassa Youth and Children Center, which actively fosters academic success through the implementation of student peer support programs. Regularly scheduled tutorials are designed to cultivate creativity and strengthen students' learning competencies. These initiatives have produced positive results, with library services

benefiting a total of 27,779 students, thereby exceeding the established target by achieving 135%. Furthermore, the library enhances the student experience by providing access to computer services and facilitating both indoor and outdoor recreational activities.

E-book services have successfully reached 4,208 students, surpassing our target by 7%. The main aim of the e-book service is to boost students' academic performance by offering access to a diverse selection of digital reference books and textbooks. This initiative involves installing these resources on computers, identifying valuable online reference materials, and providing support to students as they navigate the process of locating these books. Encouragingly, performance data reveals a steady increase in the number of users, indicating that our efforts are making a positive impact.

During the reporting period, Mary Joy Ethiopia successfully established a digital library with financial support from Mercy Hands Europe (Donor Agency). The library is equipped with a comprehensive collection of modern books, computers, and internet access. Consequently, a total of 386 youths and school-aged children benefited from the services provided by the digital library, underscoring its substantial impact and accessibility. This initiative exemplified the library's capacity to connect users with an extensive range of information and resources, thereby highlighting the essential role of technology in enhancing educational opportunities for young individuals.

In all Mary Joy project areas, a total of 16,490 children and their caregivers received home-based educational counseling, monitoring, and various forms of support, achieving 98.6% of the established objectives. Furthermore, 9,355 students, constituting 92% of the planned target, benefited from tutorial classes.

During the fiscal year, a total of 2,653 students in the sixth grade, 2,003 students in the eighth grade, and 866 students in the twelfth grade participated in regional and national examinations. The analysis of the average scores indicated that 96.6% of grade sixth, 80% of grade eighth, and 54% of grade twelfth successfully progressed to the subsequent grade level. Regarding the gender distribution of those who advanced, it was determined that 60% of the sixth-grade students who moved up were female, while 40% were male. In the eighth grade, 41% of advancing students were female, and 59% were male. Among the twelfth graders who advanced, 54% were female, and 46% were male.

Program Impacts

The increased access to educational resources and support has empowered many children who have previously faced the challenges of street life and begging. These children are now able to reconnect with their families and actively pursue their education. Additionally, the growing use of the e-book service at the Hawassa Youth Center Library indicates positive progress. This trend not only highlights the potential for further improvements to the service but also lays a strong foundation for advancing community development initiatives. Collectively, these efforts significantly contribute to the well-being of the community and the future prospects of its youth.



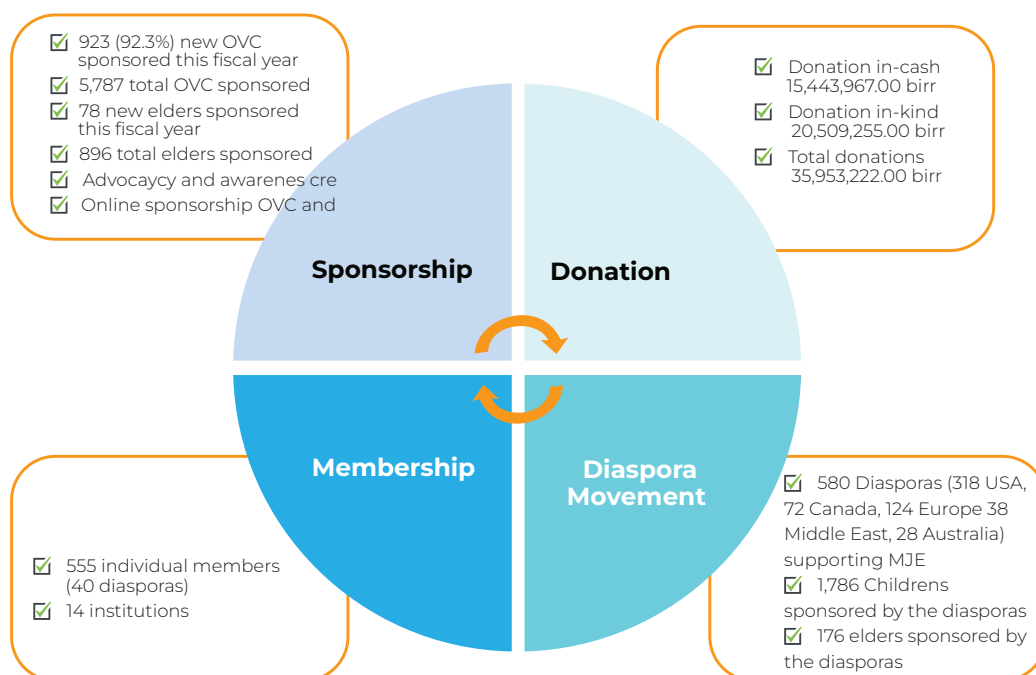
2.4. Social Protection Program

Mary Joy Ethiopia's program framework considers social protection as its crucial intervention to help protect people against shocks today and build resilience and human capital to make the most of tomorrow. This approach emphasizes not only immediate support for individuals facing challenges but also focuses on long-term development by enhancing their skills and capacities. By doing so, the program aims to empower communities to better withstand future adversities.

The effectiveness of Mary Joy Ethiopia's program framework lies in its holistic approach to social protection, which not only addresses the immediate needs of individuals facing crises but also fosters long-term resilience within communities. By integrating immediate support with sustainable development initiatives, the program equips individuals with the tools necessary to navigate current shocks while simultaneously laying the foundation for enduring stability. This dual focus empowers communities, enabling them to withstand future adversities and thrive despite challenges. Ultimately, such a comprehensive strategy underscores the importance of proactive intervention in transforming lives and promoting self-sufficiency in vulnerable populations.

2.4. Public-Private-Partnership

MJE's public-private-partnership program promotes citizen engagement and encourages private sectors to fulfill the corporate social responsibilities by supporting Orphan and Vulnerable Children (OVC) and socio economically vulnerable elders. The program has undertaken various activities during the review period, including: sponsoring children and elders, providing basic social services such as food, clothing, and healthcare, facilitating employment opportunities for unemployed youth by engaging with companies, mobilizing and placing volunteers to support the organization's operations, offering home-to-home food delivery services for bedridden and incapable elders, providing comprehensive day care and shelter services for street children, elders, and adults. Through these interventions, MJE has reached 17,964 vulnerable community members, exceeding the planned target for the review period by 12%. Summary of the key interventions and achievements through public-private-partnership are given below in the chart.



I. In-Kind Donations

This fiscal year, Ato Mesfin Tadesse and his family donated 1 hectare of land in Sendafa, Bekie town, Sheger city to Mary Joy Ethiopia that will be used to generate income for street children.



Figure 3: Ato Mesfin Tadesse and his family donated 1 hectare of land



Figure 4: Hatiko Pharma Trading has supported Mary Joy Ethiopia with various medicines



Figure 5: Jotun Ethiopia Paint Manufacturing PLC has supported the Street Children Center and the ongoing construction of Mary Joy Ethiopia



Figure 6: East Africa Bottling (Coca) Coca-Cola products supported Mary Joy Ethiopia (In-kind support)

II. Holy Day Donations

A total of 6,297,912.00 birr monetized donation items, such as food items, household utensils, clothes, shoes, and detergents were mobilized and distributed to the beneficiaries for public holidays (Fasika, Eid Mubarak, Christmas, Ethiopian new year, etc.), meeting 100% of the planned target. This distribution significantly contributed to the well-being of the target beneficiaries.



Figure 7: Prime Minister Dr. Abiy Ahmed, provided holiday support for OVC and their families



Figure 8: Repi Soap and Detergent Factory, under the theme “Pagumen with Mary Joy”, donated hygiene products and clothing to families supported by Mary Joy Ethiopia on the occasion of the 2017 Ethiopian New Year



Figure 9: Mary Joy Ethiopia, in partnership with Enat Bank, provided financial support to families in need during the 2017 New Year's Eve holiday season.



Figure 10: The FDRE Ministry of Foreign Affairs supported OVC on the occasion of the Ethiopian New Year (2017)



Figure 11: EthioTelecom Southern Region District Office supported Mary Joy Ethiopia on the International Charity Day

2.4.2. Diaspora Movement and engagement

During the reporting period, a total of 701 (364 F and 337 M) children (> 100% performance rate), and 65 (36 F and 29 M) elders have been benefited through sponsorship support by the Diaspora community. The performance of elders' sponsorship looks low because of the fact that the Diaspora preference is to support children rather than elders. Some Diaspora are very interested to support vulnerable children households with initial capital support to engage in income generation activities, and strengthening day care center that results in changes in the lives of the target groups.

In order to revitalize Diaspora participation and connections and increase awareness of the Street Children's Program among the Diaspora community, artist Abrar Abdo and Ato Amare Kassa, the deputy chairman of Mary Joy Ethiopia's Board of Directors, conducted a trip to the United States under the subject "One Diaspora for One Child." As a result of meeting in person with new volunteers, sponsors, and contributors, a wider understanding was established and the resources required for the diaspora engagement strategy were identified. Additionally, 1,426,054 birr is raised through fundraising initiatives.



Figure 12: Diaspora movement and mobilization in North America

2.4.3. Street Children and Elders Protection, Support and Rehabilitation

Mary Joy Ethiopia, the Street Life Prevention, Support, and Rehabilitation Program, has recently implemented a special focus, and the program's beneficiary cities (Addis Ababa, Arbaminch, Hawassa, and Hosanna) are working to support the social and economic reintegration of homeless and street-affected communities with their families and communities.

2.4.3.1. Gedam Sefer Street Children Center

In Addis Ababa Arada and Addis City sub-city, the rehabilitation and reintegration of vulnerable street children and mothers has been implemented in partnership with Ethiotelcom and AWACH foundations. Accordingly, 93 street children in Gedam Sefer and Asco benefited from center services that include food; clothing; health; social and psychological support and life skill trainings. The beneficiaries were given access to recreational services in addition to center service packages.

H.E. Ambassador Tamara Mona, Swiss Ambassador to Ethiopia, Djibouti, South Sudan, the African Union and IGAD, and H.E. Ambassador Leulseged Tadesse, Ethiopian Ambassador to Brazil, visited the Mary Joy Street Children's Center in Addis Ababa Gedam Sefer. During the visit, they gained a deeper understanding of the impactful work being done for street children in the community. They pledged to do their part to ensure that this work continues and expands to other locations. Ambassador Teferi Tadesse also visited the good work being done by Mary Joy Ethiopia and provided regular monthly sponsorship to children in need.



Figure 13: Switzerland Amabassador, Tamarra Mona visit to Mary Joy Ethiopia



Figure 14: Ambassador Teferi Tadesse Visit to Mary Joy Ethiopia

In the same fiscal year, Yekatit 12 Hospital Medical College staff visited the Mary Joy Ethiopia “Ethiopians for Ethiopians Movement” Coordination Office and visited the good work being done for children and the elderly. They also provided educational materials and clothing for the target OVCs. Representatives of Yekatit 12 Hospital Medical College staff, Ato Alemu Kibret and Teacher Fasil Aschelew supported the project.



Figure 15: Yekatit 12 Hospital Medical College visit to Mary Joy Ethiopia

2.4.3.2. Hawassa Elders ' Center

At the Hawassa elders' Center, 79 elders (25 women and 54 men) are receiving full-time services at the center, while 22 (5 women and 17 men) are receiving day services at the center. During the reporting period, many government authorities visited the center that includes the Director General of Agency for Civil Society Organizations, Honorable Mr. Samson Birattu, the Mayor of Dodola City, and the Mayor of Hawassa City, Mr. Mekuria Marshaye. During the visit, they stated that they will support the expansion of the community-based support and care work initiated by Mary Joy Ethiopia, and that they will work together to promote this charitable work using local resources and mobilize more funds nationwide.



Figure 16: The Director General of Ethiopian Civil Society Organizations, Honorable Mr. Samson Birattu visit to Hawassa Elders' Center



Figure 17: Dodola Mayors and government officials visit to Hawassa Elders' Center



Figure 18: Hawassa Mayor Mr. Mekuria Marshaye visit to Hawassa Elders' Center

In addition to the services they receive at the center, the elderly are making significant contributions to the center's cleaning and beautification work, vegetable and fruit cultivation, and handicrafts that generate income for the center, using their life experience, expertise, and skills. This not only has great benefits for their own physical and mental fitness and health, but also plays a significant role in generating additional income and reducing costs for the center.



Figure 19: Beautification of the center, gardening, crafting and income-generating activities by Hawassa elders' center

2.4.3.3. Arbaminch Elders' Center

In 2024 Fiscal year, the promising achievement by Mary Joy Ethiopia was the inauguration of Arbaminch elders' center for service delivery. The inauguration program was attended by the South region president H.E Mr. Tilahun Kebede, Chief Administrator of Gamo Zone Mr. Abayneh Abera, Mayor of Arbaminch City Mr. Gezahegn Gamo, Founder and General Manager of Mary Joy Ethiopia, Sr. Zebider Zewde, senior leaders of the regional, zone and city administrations, artists, Gamo elders, and honorable guests. The center designed to provide boarding services to 70 elders.



Figure 20: Arbaminch Elders Center Inauguration Program

2.4.3.4. Feeding program

In Addis Ababa, Addis Ketema Sub-city, Askto and Arada Sub-city, 93 street children are receiving services at the Street Children Centers in Gedam Sefer. Home to home feeding services were provided to 526 (102% of the plan) bedridden elderly people (360 in Addis Ababa, 121 in Hawassa (79 center service and 42 home to home feeding), 25 in Arbaminch and 20 in Hosanna). This support is provided in partnership with Lunar International College; Addis Ababa Food Agency; Hawassa and Hosanna; and by business men, hotels, and individuals.



Figure 21: Elders Feeding Program

2.4.4. Volunteerism

Volunteering has been a longstanding practice at Mary Joy Ethiopia. Volunteers mostly involved in grassroots facilitation of service delivery and home to home psychosocial services, community work mobilization; awareness and fundraising events, and contribute time, knowledge and skills. Volunteers are behind the events of the organization. Many young people from associations/ clubs have contributed greatly their support to the organization during the reporting year. Volunteers are the driving force behind the organization's success. This fiscal year, 426 new volunteers were recruited, bringing the total number of volunteers to 3,160, including existing members. They supported the organization's mission by raising funds and in-kind resources worth 10,976,000.00 birr during the fiscal year and reducing the costs of manpower.



Figure 22: The summer volunteers from Mary Joy Ethiopia's "Ethiopians to Ethiopians Movement" awareness program



Figure 23: Ruth Fasil is a summer volunteer with Mary Joy Ethiopia's "Ethiopians to Ethiopians Movement" program, where she mobilized educational, personal care, and hygiene supplies as well as useful publications for the needs of the community.



Figure 24: Negelle Arsi General Hospital has conducted cataract surgery examinations for 1,500 people, including the elderly, by philanthropic specialists from abroad.



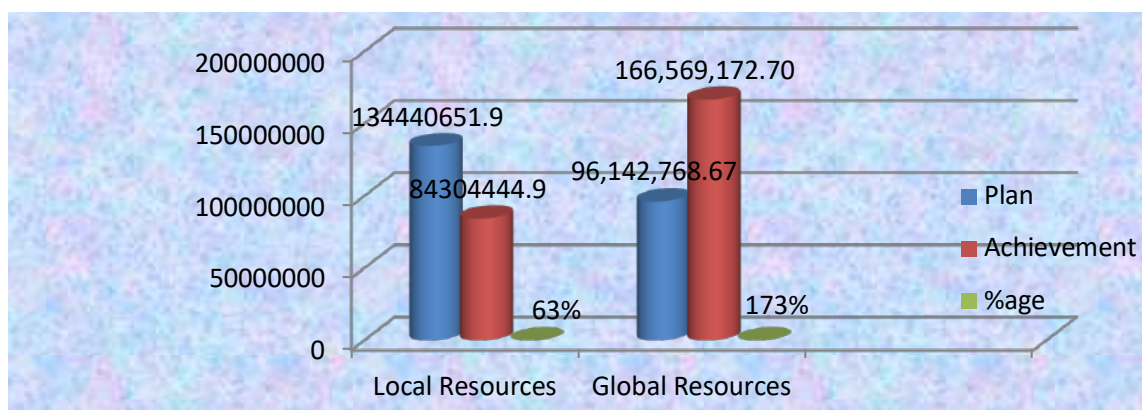
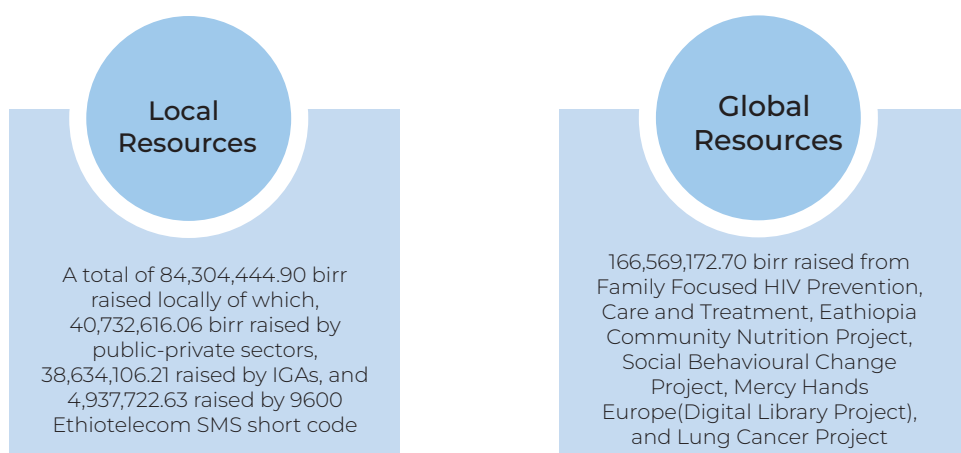
Figure 25: For our people, in our profession! Free professional services to the elderly at the Hawassa Elderly Center

Program Impacts

Through sponsorship, the lives of elderly families and children who have received help have improved, and their optimism has grown. Many kids have had the chance to attend college, universities, technical and vocational schools, and higher education institutions. They have made their own circumstances. Sponsoring organizations and philanthropic individuals are becoming more involved. Over time, the Diaspora community has been increasingly supportive of moms, young people, and vulnerable street children. In addition to expanding door-to-door feeding programs, the organization has established and organized full-time and day-care centers for children and the elderly in various cities, provided rehabilitation, behavioral change, skills training, and economic support, and improved the lives of numerous mothers, elderly people, and street-vulnerable children. Significant finance support has been secured from government agencies, and regional and zonal authorities have given the development of elders' centers a great deal of attention and oversight.

2.5. Resource Mobilization and Partnership

2.5.1. Resource Mobilization



Graph 4: Local and Global Resources Mobilized

2.5.2. Partnership

Local Partnership

- ✓ Financial institutions (banks, micro finances, etc)
- ✓ Business companies
- ✓ Universities
- ✓ Ethio telecom
- ✓ Government Institutions
- ✓ Private sectors
- ✓ Religious institutions
- ✓ Individuals
- ✓ Real states
- ✓ Local NGOS

Global Partnership

- ✓ USAID
- ✓ FHI 360
- ✓ Project Hope
- ✓ Mercy Hands Europe
- ✓ Bristol Myers Squibb Foundations
- ✓ SNV
- ✓ GAIN
- ✓ HELVATS
- ✓ Children Believe Fund,
- ✓ ABT,
- ✓ AMREF Ethiopia
- ✓ YOA4 LIFE
- ✓ CEVSI Italian based organization
- ✓ Switzerland Embassy to Ethiopia
- ✓ Ter des Hommes



Figure 26: partnership with Ethio telecom/Photo left/ Sr. Zebider with Ms. Frehiwot Tamiru/ CEO



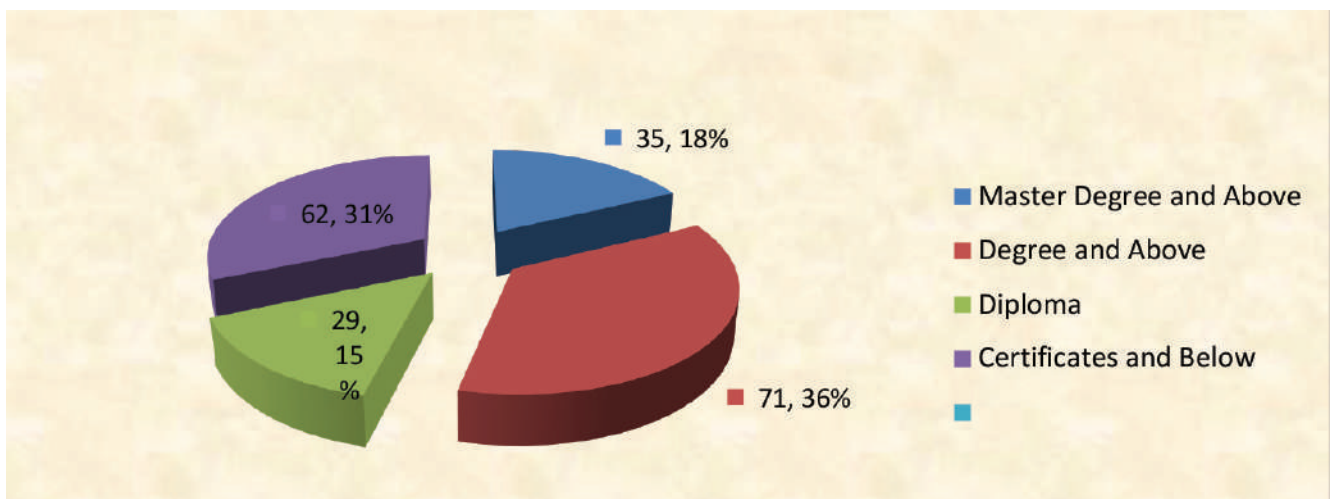
Figure 27: Partnership with Embassies (Swizerland Amabassador, Tamarra Mona)

2.6. Program Management Capacity Building

2.6.1. Human Resources Utilization and Capacity Development

The development of human resource capacity stands as a cornerstone for organizational success, as it not only elevates employee quality but also aligns individual ambitions with work-related goals. By strategically hiring new talent, and providing comprehensive training programs, Mary Joy Ethiopia cultivated a motivated and skilled workforce. Furthermore, by fostering a supportive work environment, MJE enhanced collaboration and innovation, creating a culture where employees feel valued and empowered to thrive. In addition, all Mary Joy Ethiopia staff or coordination office have been trained to implement the Key Performance Indicator (KPI) system, so that the programs/projects being implemented are measured only by key performance indicators.

During the fiscal year, there were a total of 197 employees working in Mary Joy Ethiopia's branch offices, projects and head office, of which 77 (39%) were women. Of the total employees, 89 (45%) were permanent employees of the organization and 108 (55%) were project based employees. The program staff numbered 139 (71%), while finance and administration staff numbered 58 (29%). The following graph represents the number of Mary Joy Ethiopia employees and their level of education during the reporting period.



Graph 5. Mary Joy Ethiopia's HR Level of Education

2.6.2. Strengthening Program Management, Governance and Operational Systems

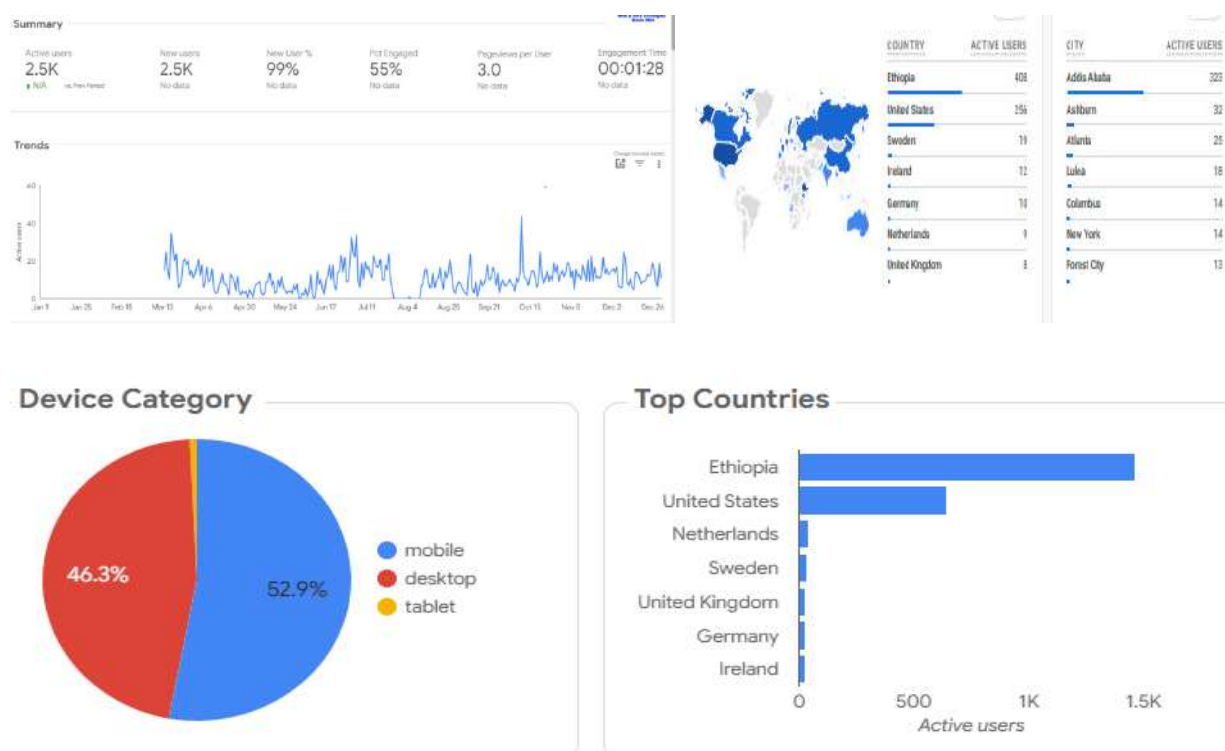
2.6.2.1 Operational Policies and Guidelines

Efforts are being made by Mary Joy Ethiopia to streamline its operations and achieve organizational goals. Improving the existing operational systems through various policies and guidelines were among the many efforts made during 2024. Various policies and guidelines are being developed, existing ones are being amended and approved, and internal procedures and decision-making are being based on guidelines in an effort to ensure compliance with the organization's laws and regulations.

2.6.2.2 Enhancing the digital system and website

Mary Joy Ethiopia achieved notable advancements in digital marketing and change in 2024. We created a system for weekly visual designs, started publishing success stories every week, and were able to safeguard all social media accounts with a centralized management system. We created a digital outgoing letter management system and added an event page to the MJE website. We redesigned the payment and purchase process on Trello, started putting the Asko branch's health management system into place, and gave numerous teams thorough training. In addition to creating a new digitization and documentation plan and a centralized digital password management sheet, we evaluated the state of digitalization across all branches. In addition, we upgraded the MJE Gallery, created new digital letterheads and put in place a system for managing it.

The Mary Joy Ethiopia website has been upgraded to help swiftly and efficiently share the organization's good work and initiatives throughout the entire world. A recent and quantifiable MJE website analytics data indicates that the Mary Joy Ethiopia website is seeing an increase in users and visitors worldwide. The Mary Joy Ethiopia website has 52,000 users as of this fiscal year, with users from Ethiopia, the United States, Sweden, Ireland, Germany, the Netherlands, and the United Kingdom among their addresses and countries. The gender distribution of users on the Mary Joy Ethiopia website shows that 35.9% are men and 64.1% are women.



Graph 7. Analysis report on the number of users, address/country, gender and content or main topic visited by users of the Mary Joy Ethiopia website

2.7 Monitoring and Evaluation

The monitoring and evaluation and support department regularly monitors implementation progress against the plan, budget utilization, identify strengths and weaknesses and present them for management decisions. The department also prepares reports and makes them available to concerned parties. In addition to weekly, monthly, and quarterly reporting, regular program monitoring and evaluation is being effected within all Mary Joy Ethiopia's structure and offices to integrate supportive supervision and mentorship to successfully achieve the organization's mission, fostering program quality, collaborative problem solving, and stronger communication between project leaders and executives.

Moreover, Mary Joy Ethiopia reports and communicates results of monitoring and evaluation findings, which can help to inform decision-making, improve accountability, enhance learning, and demonstrate impact. As a result of this, MJE has made significant improvement in reporting and communicating systems by using various formats, such as dashboards, graphs, charts, tables, and narratives.

In order to guarantee that the lessons gained and best practices are included into the execution of its program, Mary Joy Ethiopia also facilitated experience exchange between its branch offices and other organizations. The impactful program execution by Mary Joy Ethiopia has not only strengthened its internal operations but also fostered a culture of collaboration and shared learning among its various branch offices and partner organizations. By facilitating experience exchanges, the initiative created a platform where invaluable insights and successful strategies could be disseminated, ultimately enhancing the overall effectiveness of their programs. This commitment to continuous improvement and collective growth underscores the organization's dedication to achieving its mission, proving that when knowledge is shared, everyone benefits. As Mary Joy Ethiopia continues to build on these foundations, it paves the way for even greater achievements in community support and development.



Figure 28: Social Behavioral Change (USAID Healthy Behavioral Activity) supportive supervision in Guraghe zone, and Mareko special woreda



Figure 29: Supportive supervision to Dara Woreda Health Office (Sidama region), Ethiopia Community Nutrition Activity (ECNA) project



Figure 30: Social Behavioral Change (USAID Healthy Behavioral Activity) project joint support supervision in two woredas of Guraghe Zone and Marekho Special woreda.



Figure 31: High government officials from West Arsi Zone (Shashemene, Dodolla, & Hassasa) visited Mary Joy Ethiopia, Hawassa branch office



Figure 32: High level government officials from Dilla town visited Mary Joy Ethiopia, Hawassa branch office

2.8. Strengthening the Organizational Resource Base and Sustainability

2.8.1. Income Generating Activities

2.8.1.1. Expansion and Construction of Asco Primary Hospital

The construction of the Primary Hospital began in April 2024. The hospital, which occupies an area of 25x16 meters and consists of a ground floor plus three additional floors, is designed to serve the communities in and around Asko. It will include a well-established maternal and child health unit, adult ward, outpatient departments (OPDs), and specialty services, with a capacity for more than 35 beds. Currently, the construction progress is at 70% and with finishing work underway, will be completed within three months.

A committee consisting of members of the General Assembly and staff, who work tirelessly and with full dedication, has been established to support and raise funds for the construction. The committee prepared a package by identifying the building's rooms by type and number, the square meter area of each medical room, and the cost of each room, and presented it to philanthropic investors/individuals who would sponsor it. It was possible to raise funds for the construction by explaining the purpose. To date, 8,360,395.71 birr has been raised from various charitable investors/individuals.



Figure 33: Asco Primary Hospital under construction

2.8.1.2. Expansion and Construction of Hawassa Primary Hospital

As the number of service seekers coming from the kebeles and neighboring areas covered by Hawassa Mary Joy Clinic has increased significantly, and the facility has been considered for revenue generation which will be then used for the organization's social protection and empowerment program. A construction permit has been issued and a business plan has been prepared for income generation. The construction of a G+3 primary hospital has begun on a 400m² area of land.



Figure 34: Hawassa Primary Hospital under Construction

2.8.1.3. Foundation Stone Laid for Arba Minch Street Children Center

This fiscal year, the foundation stone for the construction of the Arbaminch Street Children Center was laid at the Arbaminch Elderly Care Center in the presence of the South Ethiopia Regional State Administrator, His Excellency Ato Tilahun Kebede, the Chief Administrator of Gamo Zone, Ato Abayneh Abera, the Mayor of Arbaminch City, Ato Gezahegn Gamo, the Founder and General Manager of Mary Joy Ethiopia, Sr. Zebider Zewdie, and senior leaders of the regional, zone, and city administrations.

This initiative marks a significant step towards addressing the needs of vulnerable children in the region. The involvement of high-ranking officials underscores the project's importance and the commitment of local leadership to support community welfare. The Mary Joy Ethiopia Street Children project stands as a beacon of hope for vulnerable children in Arbaminch City, driven by the collaborative efforts of local leaders and high-ranking officials. With the dedication of high government officials from the city, zone, and the region, the groundwork is set for a transformative initiative that promises to strengthen those in need. As construction prepares to commence, the collective commitment from local leadership underscores not only the importance of this project but also a shared vision for a brighter future. Through their unwavering support and proactive engagement, these leaders are paving the way for meaningful change, ensuring that the needs of vulnerable children are met with compassion and urgency.



Figure 35: Foundation Stone for Arbaminch Street Children Center Construction

2.8.1.4. Construction of Hosanna Elders' Center

Extensive fundraising and public mobilization efforts have been undertaken to complete the Elders' Center in Hosanna City. Accordingly, Pyramid Construction Company has pledged to complete the conference hall, which is part of the center's construction. The elder center in Hossana comprises income-generating components, such as a pharmacy & shops. These components are designed to provide sustainable revenue streams that will support the ongoing operations of the center. By integrating these facilities, the Elders' Center aims to enhance its financial stability and community impact. The Queen Eleni Hospital in Hosanna City pledged to provide the necessary medicines, medical equipment, and pharmaceutical supplies to make the clinical center ready for service. This collaboration ensures that the Elders' Center will have access to essential medical resources, enhancing its ability to serve the surrounding communities effectively.

2.8.1.5. Income generating shops

Mary Joy Ethiopia is working to expand its income stream by building and renting out 51 shops in Asko (24 shops), Arbaminch (18 shops), and Hawassa (9 shops). This initiative aims to enhance the organization's financial sustainability by diversifying its revenue sources. By investing in commercial properties across multiple locations, Mary Joy Ethiopia is positioning itself for long-term growth and stability. This strategy not only increases potential revenue but also mitigates risks associated with relying on a single source of income. By establishing a presence in various markets, the organization can adapt to local economic changes more effectively.

3. FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

3.1. Income

In the fiscal year, the financial performance of MJE was 148% by mobilizing 261,623,593.42 ETB of the plan 230,583,420.69 Birr. These financial resources were mobilized from the donor organizations, Diaspora, Mary Joy income generation wings and domestic resources within the country. Some new projects implementation commencement after mid-year, better performance of Diaspora awareness and mobilization overseas has contributed for the achievement of over income performance. In general, the organization income has been growing over the years, for example, fiscal year 2024 income has increased by 48 % compared to the fiscal year 2023.

Table 1: Income by source

Sources of Income	Plan	Achievement	%
Donor Agencies	96,142,768.67	166,337,021.47	173%
Public-Private-Partnership	79,578,402.00	64,951,623.07	82%
Income-generating activities (clinics, shops and others)	49,117,504.88	25,397,226.26	79%
Ethio Telecom 9600	5,744,745.14	4,937,722.62	86%
Total	230,583,420.69	261,623,593.42	148%
Beginning Balance		36,333,758.60	
Total available budget for the year		297,957,352.02	

3.2. Expenditure

During this reporting period, from the total income collected 261,623,593.42 Birr, the budget utilized was 248,477,624.78 birr (95%). Of the total expenditure, 85% was used for program activities and 15 % was used for administrative expenses. The table below depicts comparison of expenditure between program operations and administration expenses.

Table 2: Expenditure by budget component

Budget component	Plan	Achievement	%
Program expenses	208,642,366.17	210,523,678.73	101%
Administration costs	21,941,054.52	37,953,946.04	173%
Total	230,583,420.69	248,477,624.78	108%

4. PROBLEMS ENCOUNTERED AND ACTIONS TAKEN

4.1. Problems Encountered

The challenges affecting the implementation of MJE programs and fundraising activities for the 2024 budget year are as follows:

- Shortage of donor agencies and projects
- High inflation rate, escalating price of goods and services

4.2. Remedial Actions Taken

- New fundraising strategies are developed by focusing on local resources and partnerships with external donors strengthened
- Efforts have been made to prioritize and align the budget, and alternative sources of funding are being explored

5. ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

5.1. International Donor Agencies

- United States Agency for International Development/USAID/
- BMSF /Matthews Wondu Cancer Society/
- World Bank and Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs
- FHI 360
- Project Hope
- Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA)

5.2. Institutions/Companies/Individuals That Sponsor 100 or More Children

- Ethio Telecom
- Lunar International College
- Steely PLC
- Noah Real Estate PLC
- Wings of Healing PLC
- Kibir Lehiwot Church
- Tigist Ferede (Diaspora in America)
- Government Institution
- Awach Credit and Savings Financial Association
- Philanthropists
- Business Community
- Volunteers

5.3. Individuals/Organizations that supported the construction of ASCO Primary Hospital

- KK PLC
- Mr. Girmay Ferede
- Mr. Henok Tesfaye
- Mr. Biniam Tesfaye/Etete
- Fantu Supermarket
- Washinton Adventist University
- BMSF & Mathios Wondu
- Ethio telecom
- Rodas Paints
- Awash Bank
- Samcom Engineering
- Dashen Bank
- Kadco Group
- Commercial Bank of Ethiopia



6. EXTERNAL AUDITORS' REPORT



**Tesfaye Adugna Chartered Certified Accountants ' UK
Certified Auditors ' Ethiopia**

**INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT ON THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS OF
MARRY JOY ETHIOPIA
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31 DECEMBER 2024**

Section One: Report on the Financial Statements

We have audited the financial statements of Marry Joy Ethiopia, set out on Page 11 to 30, which comprise the statement of financial position as at 31 December 2024, statement of financial performance, statement of changes in net assets, a statement of cash flow, a statement of comparison of budget and actual amounts and a summary of significant accounting policies and other explanatory information for the year then ended, and notes to the financial statements, specified on page 15 to 22.

Unqualified Opinion

In our opinion, the accompanying financial statements present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of Marry Joy Ethiopia as at 31 December 2024 and its financial performance, for the year then ended, in accordance with International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS).

Basis for Unqualified Opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (ISAs). Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements* section of our report. We are independent of the Organization in accordance with the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants' code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (IESBA Code) together with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in Ethiopia, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements and the IESBA Code.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.



Responsibilities of the Management and those Charged with Governance for the Financial Statements

The management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in accordance with the accounting policies of the organization, and for such internal control as management determines is necessary to enable the preparation of the audit report that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, management is responsible for assessing the Organization's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern, and using the going concern basis of accounting unless management either intends to liquidate the organization or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so. Those charged with governance are responsible for overseeing the organization's financial reporting process.

Auditor's Responsibility for the Audit of the Financial Statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the audit report as a whole is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Section Two: Report on Other Legal and Regulatory Requirements

The opinion in this section is given based on the audit procedures we applied to review compliance with Civil Society Organization Proclamation No. 1113/2019;

1) Income: -

- a. The Organization has pre-numbered cash receipt vouchers.
- b. All income of the year has been supported by Cash Receipt voucher.
- c. As per the documents presented for us source of income are clearly identified.
- d. All income directly remitted to Bank account of the organization.
- e. All foreign income collected by the organization are legal.



2) Expenditures: -

- a. Expenses were supported by appropriate documents.
- b. The Organization has pre-numbered payment and journal vouchers.
- c. Payments were effected following payment procedures designed by the organization.
- d. Payments were approved by the management.
- e. Original documents were used as supporting evidence for expenditures.
- f. As shown on income and expenditure statement, the organization expends 84% for program and 16% for administrative costs.



3) Property, plant and equipment: -

- a. Property, plant and equipment register is maintained with necessary details.
- b. Property, plant and equipment identification number are given to each asset and cross-referenced with the register book.
- c. Property, plant and equipment counted by the management at year end.
- d. Property, plant and equipment register maintained by the management.

4) Advances to partners organization

- a. Advances to partners organization are a consequence of such transfer of cash funds, less reported disbursements
- b. The balance represents unutilized grant transferred to local partners.

5) Cash and bank balances

- a. The details of banks used by the organization are known.
- b. Bank reconciliation is prepared on monthly basis.
- c. Bank statements of each bank accounts operated by the organization are made available.

6) Creditors

- a. All liabilities were classified under current category.
- b. Taxes and pension are deducted and paid over to the tax authority within the time set for settlements.

7) Compliance with the project agreement

- a. The project agreement has been adhered to and related project funds have been used exclusively for the purpose of the project in accordance with the project agreement.

In our opinion, the attached financial statements of Mary Joy Ethiopia as at 31 December 2024, in all material respect, complies with Civil Society Organization Proclamation No. 1113/2019 issued by the FDRE Agency for Civil Society Organizations.



Tesfaye Adugna Certified Audit Firm
Chartered Certified Accountants (UK)
Authorized Auditors (Eth)



Addis Ababa
28 March 2024



MARY JOY ETHIOPIA
STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
AS AT 31 DECEMBER 2024

Currency :- Ethiopian Birr

ASSETS	Note	2024	2023
NON CURRENT ASSETS			
Property, plant and equipment	2.1b, 6	26,314,148.59	27,494,634
Investment	7	2,670,000.00	2,670,000
		28,984,148.59	30,164,634
CURRENT ASSETS			
Cash and cash equivalents	2.1m, 8	38,061,115.31	16,968,705
Sundry and other receivable	8	5,575,220.02	9,346,911
Inventories	2.1f, 14	1,144,552.78	975,940
		44,780,888.11	27,291,556
TOTAL ASSETS		73,765,036.71	57,456,189
LIABILITIES AND NET ASSETS			
CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Trade and other payables	2.1e ii, 10	3,264,232.86	1,895,389
Employee benefit	11	3,252,358.15	257,910
Leave obligation	12.1	597,118.40	597,118
		7,113,709.41	2,750,417
NON CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Employee benefit obligation	3, 12.2	1,729,551.39	1,727,926
TOTAL LIABILITIES		8,843,260.80	4,478,344
NET ASSETS		64,921,775.91	52,977,846
REPRESENTED BY:			
Fund Balance		39,498,530.47	26,427,290
IPSAS Translation Reserves		23,763,269.94	24,943,755
Accumulated surplus		1,659,975.49	1,606,801
TOTAL EQUITY		64,921,775.91	52,977,846



MARY JOY ETHIOPIA
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS/ EQUITY
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31 DECEMBER 2024

Currency:- Ethiopian Birr

	Fund Balance	Translation reserve	Accumulated surplus/ Deficit	Total Net Asset/ Equity
Balance as at 01 January 2024	26,427,290	24,943,755	1,606,801	52,977,846
Prior year Adjustment			53,175	
PPE Accumulated Depreciation		(1,180,484.92)		(1,180,484.92)
Surplus for the period	13,071,240.32			13,071,240.32
Balance as at 31 December 2023	39,498,530.47	23,763,269.94	1,659,975.49	64,868,601.08



MARRY JOY ETHIOPIA
STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31 DECEMBER 2024

Currency: Ethiopian Birr

		<u>2023</u>
<u>Cash flow from operating activities</u>		
Surplus/Deficit for the year	11,890,755.41	8,731,587.95
Less: Adjustment- opening balance difference	54,799.88	483,131.91
	<u>11,945,555.29</u>	<u>9,214,719.86</u>
Adjustment for non- cash income and expenses		
Deprecation	1,180,484.92	1,140,045.04
Change in working capital:		
(Increase)/decrease in sundry receivable	3,771,690.73	(7,608,427.35)
(Increase)/decrease in Inventory	(168,612.62)	(63,299.10)
Increase/(decrease) in creditors (other current liabilities)	1,368,843.85	(1,873,296.76)
Increase/(decrease) in Employee benefit severance liability	<u>2,994,448.24</u>	<u>214,920.46</u>
	<u>21,092,410.40</u>	<u>1,024,662.15</u>
Cash (used in)/ generated from operating activities	<u>21,092,410.40</u>	<u>1,024,662.15</u>
Cash flow from investing activities		
Acquisition of investment	-	(2,670,000.00)
Purchase of plant, property and equipment	-	(568,338.87)
Net cash flow from investing activities	<u>-</u>	<u>(3,238,338.87)</u>
Cash flow from financing activities		
Net cash in flow from finance activities	-	-
Net increase /decrease in cash and cash equivalents	21,092,410.40	(2,213,676.72)
Cash and cash equivalent at the beginning of the year	16,968,704.92	19,182,381.64
Cash and cash equivalent at the end of the year	<u>38,061,115.31</u>	<u>16,968,704.92</u>
Components of cash and cash equivalents		
Cash at bank	38,061,115.31	16,968,704.92
	<u>38,061,115.31</u>	<u>16,968,704.92</u>



7. ANNEXES

7.1 Success Stories

Women Empowerment in Action: The “Yelem Liyunet” VSLA Journey



Loan Association (VSLA), supported by the USAID's FFHPCT activity, empowering women by enhancing their economic independence and access to HIV-related health and social services in Ethiopia. A year ago, a determined group of 13 women, who received a VSLA training organized by the USAID/FFHPCT activity team at Butajira, set out on a mission to improve their entrepreneurial capabilities. They had been struggling, but could not be successful due to lack of essential knowledge in this field, which made them vulnerable to economic dependency and ineffective saving habits.

After obtaining the training, they began their journey by saving 50 ETB bi-weekly, pooling their resources to create a brighter future. Their collective efforts allowed them to convert their savings into small loans, which have been instrumental in starting businesses focusing to local products and handcrafted items. Each loan has not only fostered trust among the members but also met with responsible re-payments.

Furthermore, the USAID/FFHPCT teams provided a business development services (BDS) training, equipping women with essential skills needed to successfully run their businesses, all with the support of dedicated ES animators. Partnering with Meklit Micro Finance Association, they increased their monthly savings to 200 ETB and accessed loans based on their deposits, motivating them to pursue greater aspirations.

Beyond fulfilling their daily financial obligations, they are now in a position to address their essential needs while also planning to advance their loan and develop their businesses, all while maintaining a suppressed viral load and stable health. Their journey highlights the transformative power of collaboration and targeted support in advancing women's empowerment. It is essential to recognize and celebrate their journey, in light of MJE's focused efforts on women empowerment.

Resilience in Adversity:” Melat’s Journey to Empowerment”



Melat Debalke, a 19-years old resident of Arbaminch, faced significant challenges stemming from her family’s financial hardships. Originally from Addis Ababa, Melat’s family struggled to afford her education and medical care, ultimately leading to their relocation to Arbaminch. Unfortunately, their circumstances did not improve after the move. At the age of thirteen, Melat learned that she had been living with HIV since birth, which added to her emotional and psychological burdens as she navigated the ages of adolescence.

Despite the difficulties, Melat remained committed to her health and education. After her family faced further complications such as her father’s unexpected departure and her sister’s relocation. Melat began to experience increased stress, leading to missed school days and a halt in her antiretroviral therapy (ART) medication. However, she was eventually located by the USAID-FFHPCT Activity Arbaminch SNU team, who provided intensive counseling, support, and medical services aimed at re-engaging her in treatment.

Through the dedicated efforts of the FFHPCT Activity team, Melat was able to achieve viral suppression within three months. She completed her education by earning a diploma from Arbaminch Vocational Training College. Additionally, economic assistance was provided to her mother, which significantly improved their household situation and stability.

Melat’s journey underscores the effectiveness of the USAID/FFHPCT program in addressing local HIV challenges and advancing the global 95-95-95 strategy. Her story exemplifies the resilience and determination of individuals facing adversity, as well as the profound impact of comprehensive HIV care and support on improving lives and fostering empowerment.

FY 2025 Budget

FY2025 Budget Plan by Cost Category/Programs

The program and admin proportion is 89.8% to 10.2%. The proportion in the table above indicates Mary Joy Ethiopia has given prior attention to preventive & curative health care services; the other focus area is social protection through diversified programs. The overall disbursement of the budget for each program's cost category is summarized as follow in table 2:

Program component	Budget (ETB)	Percentage share
1. Health	106,868,740.41	34
2. Economic strengthening	5,008,461.00	1.6
3. Social Protection	90,703,937.00	29
4. Education	6,279,200.00	2
5. Infrastructure /Construction	16,638,000.00	5
6. Supportive supervision /travel	5,286,372.00	1.7
7. Organizational Development and Sustainability	28,298,087.59	9
8. Personnel salary and benefit	24,585,991.4	8
Program Total	283,668,789.40	89.8
1. Equipment and supplies	529,723.84	0.17
2. Admin staff salary and benefit	16,553,926.87	5
3. Admin (other direct costs)	15,063,824.30	4.8
Total admin	32,147,475.01	10.2
Total budget plan for the year 2025	315,816,264.41	100%

Figure 36: FY2025 Budget Plan by Major Programs Cost Category

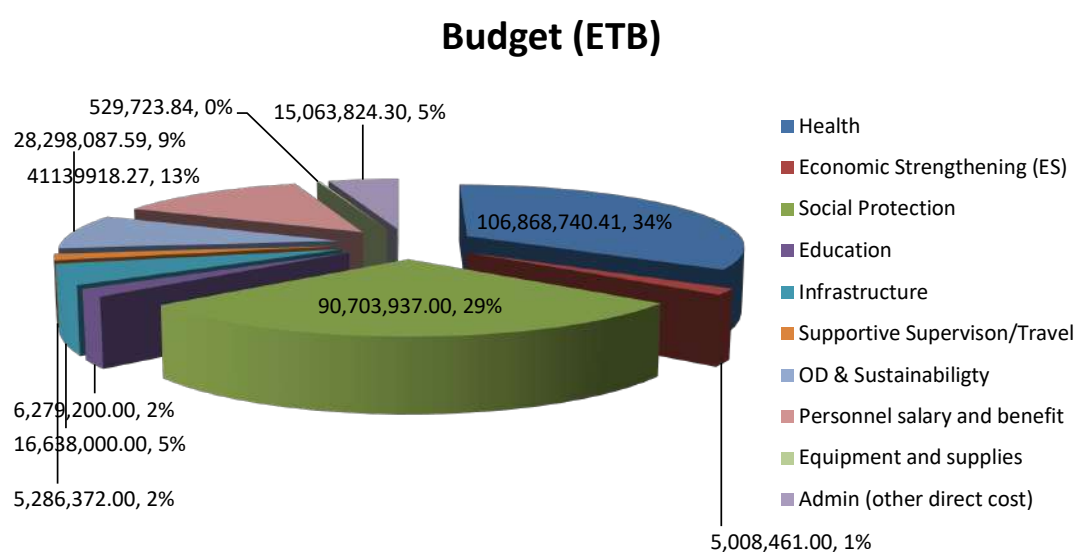


Table 4: Budget Summary by Source and Quarterly Plan

Budget Source	Annual budget	% share	Quarter Distribution and plan (\$)			
			Quarter 1	Quarter 2	Quarter 3	Quarter 4
Grants from Donors	178,873,612.00	56.6%	32,578,616.82	55,367,851.33	48,072,671.60	42,854,472.25
Local Resource mobilization	42,512,488.41	13.5%	7,971,091.90	13,285,192.96	11,159,522.55	10,096,681.00
Asco & Hawassa Clinics, Primary Hospital Construction	29,563,893.00	9.4%	5,543,229.82	7,021,424.00	7,760,522.03	9,238,717.15
Target towns ETEM & Center constructions, private sector Elders nutrition, care and support	54,699,211.00	17.3%	10,276,666.09	15,649,812.31	13,926,713.35	14,846,019.25
Diaspora	2,820,000.00	0.9%	352,500.00	705,000.00	810,750.00	951,750.00
IGA	1,175,000.00	0.4%	164,500.00	232,650.00	343,100.00	434,750.00
Ethiotelecom 9600	6,172,060.00	2%	1,388,713.5	1,465,864.25	1,620,165.75	1,697,316.5
Total	315,816,264.41	100%	58,275,318.13	93,727,794.85	83,693,445.28	80,119,706.15

Table 5: Human Resource Forecast for the Fiscal Year 2025

Description	Existed	Forecasted	Total manpower
Existed Program staff	139	30	169
Administration	58	10	68
Total	197	40	237